UNIVERSITY OF NOTRE DAME

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## Teaching Experience

At Notre Dame, I have gained experience as both a teaching assistant and instructor of record at the undergraduate level. In Fall 2022, I served as a teaching assistant for Kirk Doran's *Principles of Microeconomics* course, where I created and graded exams and held supplemental office hours. As demand for office hours grew, I began leading a weekly tutorial focused on reviewing challenging course material. I then served as a teaching assistant for Cora Bennett's *Statistics for Economists* course in Spring 2023, where I led a weekly recitation reviewing lecture material and introducing students to programming in Stata. I earned a median composite evaluation score of 4.9/5 for this recitation.

In summer 2024, I served as the instructor of record for *Principles of Microeconomics* through Notre Dame's Summer Bridge program. My class was designed to give student-athletes, most of whom came from disadvantaged or underrepresented backgrounds, a longer on-ramp in their transition to college by allowing them to take courses before the fall semester. I received a median composite evaluation score of 4.1/5 as the instructor of this course. At Notre Dame, a score of 4 indicates very good teaching, and instructors are expected to perform above this level. Both of my median composite scores exceed this standard.

Based on my teaching experience and research expertise, I am prepared and excited to teach undergraduate principles and intermediate courses in microeconomics and macroeconomics, statistics, econometrics, causal inference and quasi-experimental methods, and field courses in public, labor, and education economics.

## Teaching Philosophy and Methods

My teaching philosophy is guided by three core tenets: (1) motivate student effort by demonstrating a genuine investment in their success, (2) create an active learning environment that develops economic intuition and reasoning, and (3) stimulate interest in economics by connecting course material to students' lives and real-world problems.

I believe students are more willing to invest in a course when they see that their instructor is equally invested in their success. My effort to demonstrate this investment begins before the first day of class, when I memorize the names of all my students so that I can engage with them personally from the outset. I also use the first day to communicate expectations for both students and myself as the instructor. By making it clear that my role is to make the path to success obvious, but not trivial, I build mutual respect through transparency and accountability. I view each quiz as an opportunity to learn and provide students with personalized feedback on the skills they have mastered, are beginning to understand, and still need to develop. When students underperform relative to their expectations, I reach out to offer advice on how to learn the material and provide additional practice. For example, after midterms I provide students with a review of their progress that identifies areas where they may be struggling and additional practice targeted to those areas. I also make myself available for individual meetings when students cannot attend regularly scheduled office hours.

I strive to create an active learning environment that helps students develop economic intuition before formalizing new concepts. Before introducing a definition or model, I begin with leading

questions and familiar examples that encourage students to reason through the behavior or phenomenon we are about to study and form expectations about what should occur. After introducing the concept or model, I have students work in groups to answer in-class "clicker" questions that test their understanding and ability to apply what they have learned. Their responses allow me to assess comprehension in real time and adjust the lecture to spend additional time on concepts students find most difficult. I also use games to illustrate key economic concepts, including gains from trade, diminishing marginal returns, and game theory. These activities give students multiple opportunities to practice economic reasoning during class and reinforce concepts that may be more difficult to understand through lecture alone.

Beyond helping students master individual concepts, I want them to see economics as a useful framework for understanding issues they encounter in their own lives and interests. I therefore incorporate activities that ask students to identify and analyze economic ideas outside the classroom. Because my *Principles of Microeconomics* course consisted entirely of student-athletes, we discussed the market power of organizations such as the NCAA and MLB. I also assigned weekly "reaction statements" in which students selected a current issue or form of media, such as a podcast or news article, and explained how it related to concepts covered in the course. These assignments encouraged students to recognize economics in settings they found personally relevant while requiring them to synthesize material across topics and apply economic reasoning independently.

I view every teaching experience as an opportunity to grow and improve. Throughout the semester, I gather student feedback through anonymous surveys and discussions so that I can adjust the course to better meet students' needs. Student feedback has also identified clarity of explanation as an area for continued growth, particularly when presenting difficult concepts. I welcome this feedback and reflect weekly on what worked well and what I could improve in future lectures. Together, these practices allow me to address shortcomings in real time and continually refine my teaching to provide the best experience for my students.

## Evaluations

My teaching evaluation scores and selected comments from *Principles of Microeconomics* are below. My website includes full evaluations and CIFs for all courses, along with selected comments from students who requested that I lead a recitation section while serving as a teaching assistant for Kirk Doran's *Principles of Microeconomics* course.

**- Please comment on how well the activities, readings, lectures, and assignments helped you learn in this course**

- "The assignments and readings were thoughtfully chosen and planned and were very beneficial"
- "It helped me understand the material very well"

**- Please identify what you perceive to be the greatest strengths of this instructor's teaching**

- "His genuine passion for the subject and his willingness to go above and beyond to increase his students understanding of the subject"
- "He is very passionate about the course, wants to help students, is available outside of class to clear up any misunderstandings, and is very understanding of busy students' schedules and does his best to accommodate"
- "He is very enthusiastic, is willing to keep helping you until you understand the topic"
- "His ability to demonstrate on the chalk board"

# Course Evaluation Summary

## Principles of Microeconomics (ECON-10010-01)

Division: Social Sciences | Department: Economics | Course Level: 1 | Campus: Main | Invited: 14 | Respondents: 10 | Response Rate: 71.4%

## Composite Summary

### Composite Median

| |
|---|
| 4.1 |

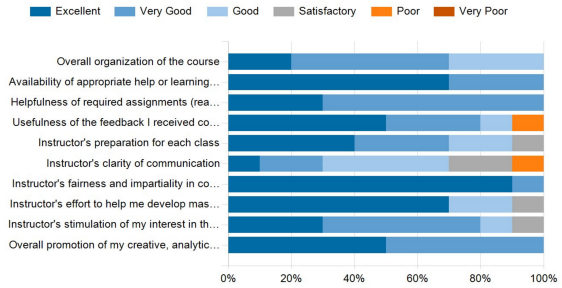
### Composite Summary

| Overall of All Questions | | |
|---|---|---|
| % Excellent or V Good | % Poor or V Poor | Item Responses |
| 80.0% | 2.0% | 100 |

## Course Insights

| Question | Strongly Agree | Somewhat Agree | Somewhat Disagree | Strongly Disagree | Not sure/No opinion |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| The instructor was respectful of students and their points of view. | 100.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| The instructor was accessible to students outside class time. | 100.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| The instructor effectively promoted my learning in this area. | 90.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| The assignments and activities of this course effectively promoted my learning in this area. | 80.0% | 20.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| I felt engaged in this course. | 80.0% | 20.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |

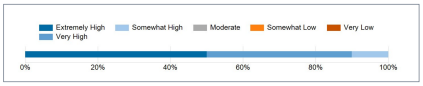
## Instructor Evaluation Results




## Detailed Evaluation Results

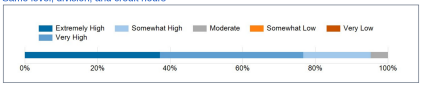
| Question | Excellent | Very Good | Good | Satisfactory | Poor | Very Poor |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Overall organization of the course | 20.0% | 50.0% | 30.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Availability of appropriate help or learning resources outside class | 70.0% | 30.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Helpfulness of required assignments (readings, projects, etc.) in facilitating my learning | 30.0% | 70.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Usefulness of the feedback I received concerning my work in the course | 50.0% | 30.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% |
| Instructor's preparation for each class | 40.0% | 30.0% | 20.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Instructor's clarity of communication | 10.0% | 20.0% | 40.0% | 20.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% |
| Instructor's fairness and impartiality in conducting the class | 90.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Instructor's effort to help me develop mastery of the course material | 70.0% | 0.0% | 20.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Instructor's stimulation of my interest in the subject matter | 30.0% | 50.0% | 10.0% | 10.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |
| Overall promotion of my creative, analytical or critical thinking | 50.0% | 50.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% | 0.0% |

## Quality of Student Effort




## Student Effort Comparison Group

Same level, division, and credit hours




## Intellectual Challenge

